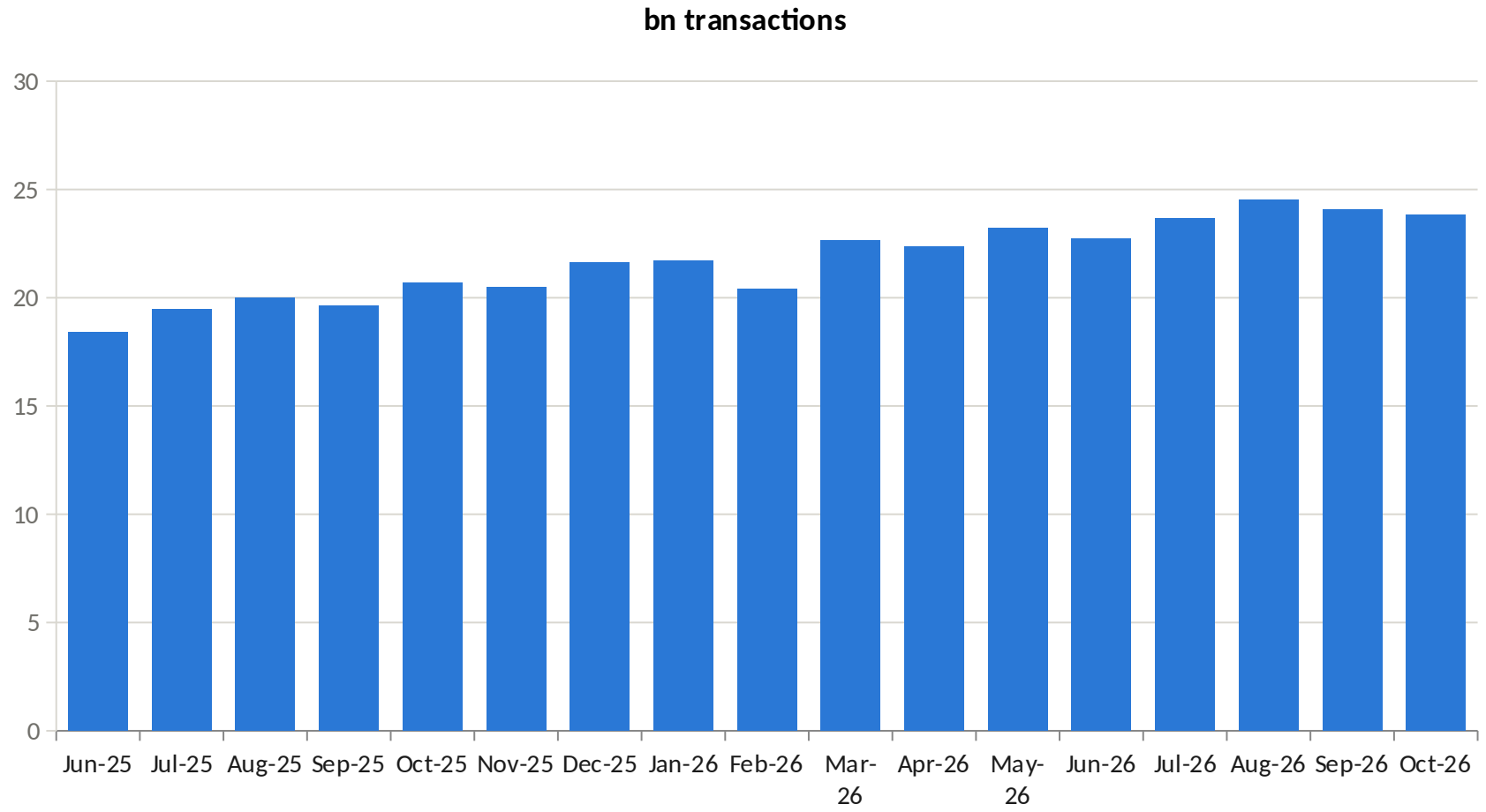
VOLUME

UPI peaked at 24.51 bn transactions in Aug-26 and has plateaued since; Oct-26 was 23.83 bn, not the 25.47 bn widely reported



Avg ticket Rs 1,228 (Oct-26)
Value Rs 29.25 lakh cr

The secondary-press figure for Oct-26 does not match NPCI's own file: always check against source.

Source: NPCI UPI product statistics and app-wise statistics; DFS FAQ on MDR (15 Sep 2026); PIB FY26 release (P2M share)

The new MDR creates a Rs 9k-24k cr annual pool from <5% of merchant volume; the range hinges on how much P2M value sits above Rs 2,000

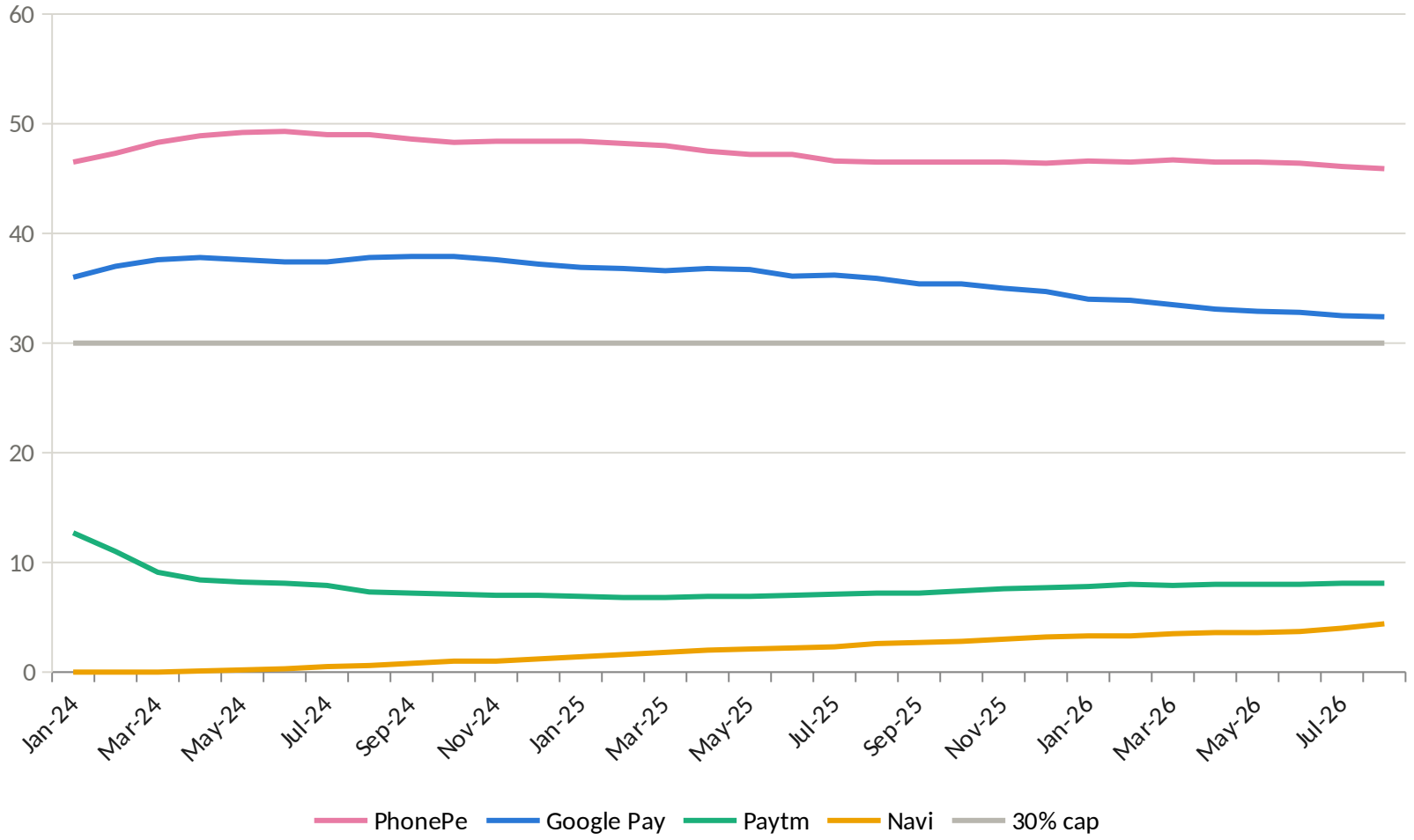
P2M value above Rs 2k \ exempt share	10%	20%	30%	40%
40%	13,694	12,172	10,651	9,129
50%	17,117	15,215	13,313	11,411
60%	20,540	18,258	15,976	13,694
70%	23,964	21,301	18,639	15,976

Rules (DFS FAQ): 0.4% on P2M > Rs 2,000; Rs 300 cap at >= Rs 75,000; Rs 5 flat for railways, telecom, insurance, fuel; P2PM small merchants (<= Rs 1 lakh/month) and AutoPay mandates exempt.

The fee lands on large merchants: a value-driven, concentrated pool.

Source: NPCI UPI product statistics and app-wise statistics; DFS FAQ on MDR (15 Sep 2026); PIB FY26 release (P2M share). Pool = trailing-12m value x 29% P2M x share above Rs 2,000 x (1 - exempt) x 0.4% x 0.95 cap haircut

The 30% cap is out of reach by Dec-26: PhonePe (45.9%) would need to shed 4.0 pp a month; its 12-month trend is -0.03 pp



HHI 3,247 (Aug-26), down from a 3,905 peak as Navi (4.4%) gains.

Likely outcome: another extension or phased glide path rather than hard enforcement on 1 Jan 2027 (judgement).

Source: NPCI UPI product statistics and app-wise statistics; DFS FAQ on MDR (15 Sep 2026); PIB FY26 release (P2M share). Trend = OLS slope of monthly share, last 13 months. Extension is a judgement, not a reported fact